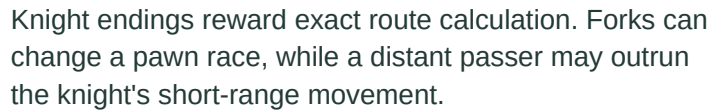


Knight-ending routes

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES



Map the knight's checking moves and its route to the critical blockade square. Count moves rather than judging distance by appearance.

The defending king is on f5. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

43.Ne3+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. Recorded reply: **43...Ke6**.

44.Kxf4 The king captures the knight on f4. Recorded reply: **44...g5+**.

45.hxg5 The pawn captures the pawn on g5.

At the end, nominal material is White 7 / Black 4 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +4. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +4: the balance goes from -1 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

A knight changes color with every move and may need a detour. Check the route square by square before trusting a race estimate.